

every way. While this may be true, the Macintosh lost market share due to a number of factors, the primary one being that Apple insisted that it supply all the hardware *and* software for the Mac. Windows, on the other hand was available on any PC that supported the IBM PC standard. A combination of factors helped Microsoft gain market share while the Mac OS languished. Of late, there has been renewed interest in the Mac; more and more people have begun buying Macs again. In March 2001, Apple introduced a new version of the Mac called Mac OS X (pronounced Mac OS *ten*). This was a complete rewrite of the entire Macintosh operating system and based on the UNIX operating system core.

6.1.4 Operating System

The software that drives the computer. Over the years many operating systems have been born (many more have died!). Commonly referred to as the “OS”, the operating system is the software that communicates with the hardware and provides the environment for software applications to run. There are many different types of operating systems with some being created for a specific purpose. Popular examples of operating systems are Windows, Mac OS, Linux, UNIX and others. Even cell phones and PDAs have operating systems. Windows CE, Symbian OS and Palm OS are popular among handhelds and PDAs.

6.1.5 Shell

On UNIX and UNIX-like systems, the shell is the section of the operating system that interprets text commands for the computer execute. It is a command-line interface which means that any commands have to be in text form only. The shell is just one layer above the operating system and hence is a very powerful tool that can be used to do things that would normally be difficult with a GUI. In the right hands, the shell can be used to do perform powerful tasks like modifying files and folders; conversely, in the wrong hands, it could be devastating for your system. The shell in Windows is the DOS prompt that is still available for die-hard command-line fans.